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Living With Fibromyalgia for 16 Years: Pain, Recovery Through Homeopathy, and Relapse

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M.A. Subbaraman shares his long journey through chronic pain, failed treatments, temporary recovery, and the return of Fibromyalgia after years of relief.

It was in February 2010. I was 64 years old and working in Mumbai when I started getting pain in my limbs and experiencing pins and needles sensation in my feet. I consulted a neurologist and, as directed by him, underwent a nerve conduction test, which was normal. With some medication, the symptoms settled. Thereafter, the pain used to come and go, and at times it improved on its own.

In March 2006, I was diagnosed with Mitral Valve prolapse and started taking Ecosprin 75 mg daily. After an angioplasty in July 2012, I was prescribed Rosuvastatin 20. Around the same time, my weight dropped significantly and the pain in my limbs returned, though the nerve conduction test remained normal. Reducing the Statin dosage gave no relief.

From 2013 onwards, I started finding difficulty in walking and felt that my muscles had lost strength. During this period, I also suffered a severe asthma attack, which settled by October 2013. But after this, the body pain returned once again, this time continuously and severely.

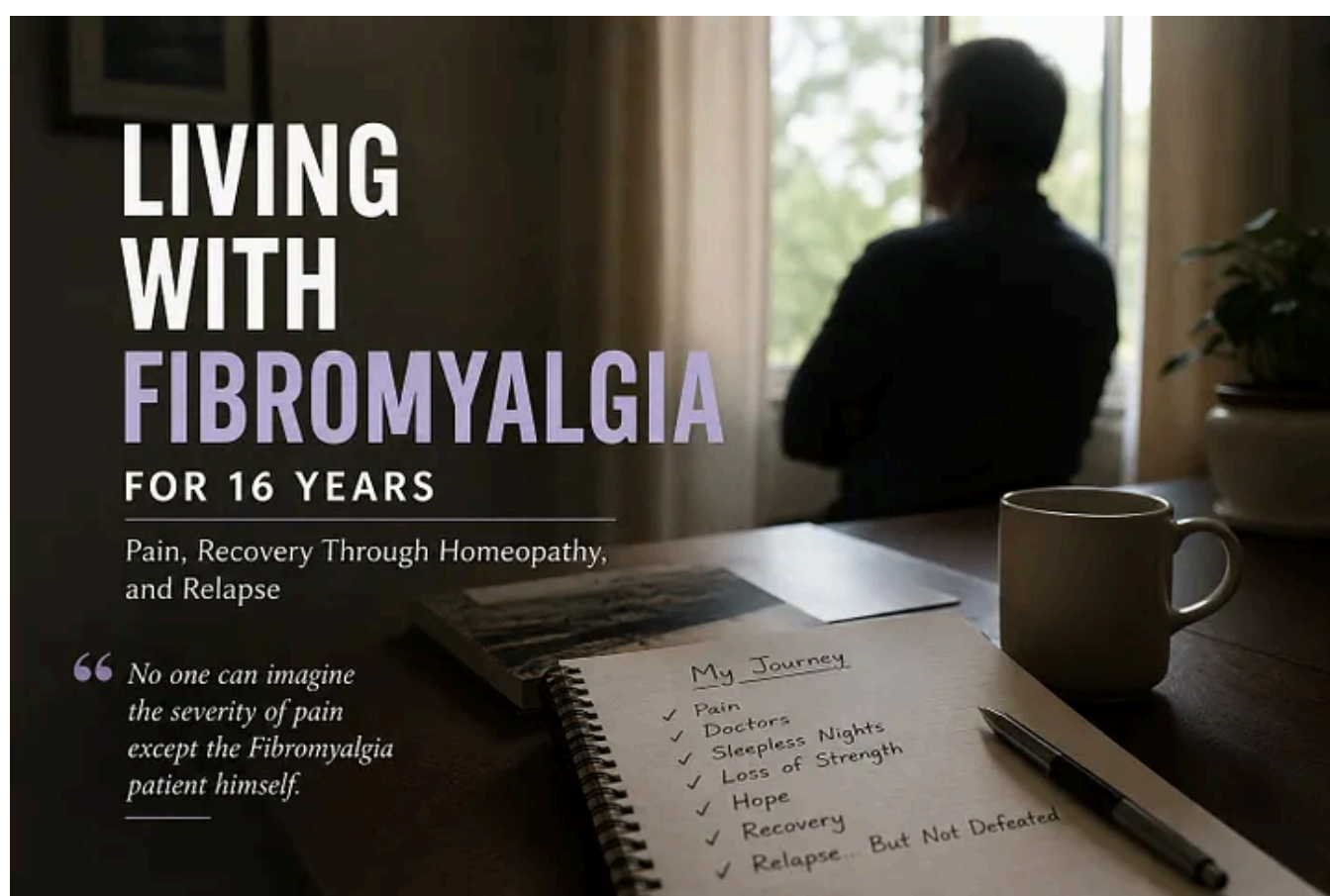
I consulted neurologists again, who directed me back to the cardiologist to rule out the possibility of Statin medicine causing muscle pain. The cardiologist asked me to

stop Rosuvas for 10 days and observe. Since the pain did not subside, that possibility was ruled out.

The neurologist prescribed Pregalin. It only gave side effects and no pain relief.

Then began the long journey through doctors and hospitals. Rheumatologists, chest specialists, urologists, and orthopedic specialists all tried to diagnose the problem, but without success.

Doctors categorically told me there was no permanent cure for this illness and that medicines were only meant to manage the pain. One doctor even advised me to stop all medicines and go for “relaxation therapy” and “meditation.”



Living With Fibromyalgia

During this period, I spoke with other Fibromyalgia patients over the phone to discuss symptoms and treatment experiences. I realized the intensity of Fibromyalgia varies from patient to patient.

No one can imagine the severity of pain except the Fibromyalgia patient himself. Fibromyalgia touches

many parts of a patient's life. Patients struggle to control symptoms and adapt to the limitations and stresses brought by the illness. Some stop working, reduce their working hours, or retire completely.

Fortunately, in my case, I managed to continue working till 31 August 2017, by which time I was 72 years old. I found that working helped me forget the pain for some time. My work environment was also excellent, and I received full cooperation from seniors and staff.

But physically, I increasingly felt incapacitated. I tried Ayurvedic treatment, Pranic healing, Chiropractic therapy, all without success. I also tried Homeopathy with the same doctor who had cured my mother during an acute illness in 1992. But this too did not initially help, and the doctor eventually asked me to consult someone else as she had almost stopped active practice.

I also referred my case to doctors in Canada and the USA through relatives. They prescribed antidepressants like Lyrica and Gabapentin, medicines I had already tried without success. Their underlying message too was the same:

There is no cure for Fibromyalgia. By then, I had consulted around 22 allopathic doctors across multiple hospitals in Mumbai and had almost lost all hope.

When Things Became Unbearable

From 15 December 2014 onwards, pain in my neck and shoulder also started. The pain became unbearable and I practically had no strength in my legs.

Despite this, I continued travelling nearly 50 km daily to office.

I used to press my hands and legs during work when the pain became unbearable. It became difficult to operate the computer due to pain. I constantly moved my legs because of restless leg syndrome. Oddly, staying engaged in office work gave some temporary relief, perhaps because it diverted my thoughts.

Sleep became a luxury. Even on the rare occasion when I slept well, I woke up feeling sleepy and exhausted. My anxiety levels became very high. Alongside this came:

- fatigue,
- poor concentration,
- dizziness,
- imbalance,
- memory issues,
- slurred speech,
- and constant exhaustion.

At this point, one of my well-wishers directed me to meet a Homeopathy doctor in Mumbai.

The Homeopathy Consultation

I met the doctor on 18 December 2014 with all my reports. The consultation lasted more than two hours. The doctor carefully took my complete history and listened to every symptom, including:

- Acute pain in limbs, body, shoulders, and neck
- Restless leg syndrome
- Difficulty walking
- Difficulty using mobile phones and computers
- Depression and anxiety
- Dizziness and rashes
- Poor memory
- Coordination problems
- Fatigue
- Sleep disorder
- Poor concentration
- Constant urge to lie down

- Drowsiness and imbalance
- Slurred speech
- Significant weight loss

After discussions, the doctor prescribed medicines for one week and asked me to return every week for follow-up. The doctor also advised me to start walking, something that initially felt impossible.

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I began by walking inside the house for five minutes at a time, resting in between. Slowly this became 10 minutes, then 15 minutes. Though I did not experience substantial relief immediately, I continued my weekly follow-ups.

I did not lose hope because I believed Homeopathy would take time to act.

Gradual Relief

After nearly four months, the intensity of pain slowly began reducing. But it took nearly eight months to experience real comfort.

I still remember 15 August 2015 clearly.

We had gone to a resort where we needed to walk nearly 15 minutes from our room to the dining hall. Initially, we considered having food brought to the room because I believed walking that distance would be impossible. But I attempted the walk. And I completed it without much difficulty.

I was extremely happy. That moment gave me confidence for the first time in years. I continued weekly consultations till August 2017 and regularly updated the doctor about any symptom changes. By 2016, nearly 80% of my original pain and associated

symptoms had disappeared. Occasionally, if I exerted too much, shooting pains or symptoms would return, but the doctor would address them.

Even after retirement on 31 August 2017, I continued consultations every two weeks because I remained afraid that the disease could flare up again at any time. During the Covid period, the pain had almost subsided completely, but I still continued telephonic consultations and medicines till January 2022.

Fibromyalgia Returns

Although I had experienced significant relief from Fibromyalgia by 2016 through Homeopathy, the illness resurfaced recently.

The beginning was neck pain, which I initially assumed was an orthopedic problem. The doctor prescribed medicines for 10 days. I also underwent physiotherapy for another 10 days, but there was no relief.

Then, on 28/03/2026, I was diagnosed with Herpes on my forehead and head. I consulted a dermatologist on 29/03/2026 who prescribed antiviral medicines and ointment for seven days. Although the spread of Herpes stopped, the neck pain continued. The doctor explained that it could take time because the pain was related to Herpes.

Until then, I had been walking for 30 minutes daily without difficulty. But by the first week of May 2026, walking and standing once again became difficult. The pain in my neck gradually spread to my shoulders, hands, and legs with high intensity, very similar to the symptoms during my earlier Fibromyalgia episode.

To reconfirm the condition, I underwent blood tests on 13/05/2026. Most parameters were normal, and the doctor confirmed that it was Fibromyalgia again. He prescribed antidepressants along with Calcium and Vitamin D supplements. However, I could not tolerate the antidepressants because of severe nausea.

On 19/05/2026, I once again met the Homeopathy doctor who had treated me earlier. Since then, I have restarted Homeopathic medicines.

At present, the pain feels even more intense compared to my earlier episode. But I remain hopeful that this phase too will eventually settle.

A Personal Reflection

Living with Fibromyalgia has been one of the most difficult experiences of my life. The illness not only affects the body but also deeply impacts the mind, emotions, work life, sleep, mobility, confidence, and relationships. My journey taught me that chronic pain is not always visible to others, but it can completely transform the life of the person experiencing it.

Based on my own experience, I personally believe Homeopathy helped me significantly over the years, especially through continuous follow-up and detailed interaction with the doctor. At the same time, I understand that every patient's experience with Fibromyalgia is different.





Today, even as the illness has resurfaced, I continue to hold on to hope.

Because after living through years of pain once before, I know that even difficult phases can slowly change with time, support, treatment, and perseverance.

Editor's Note:

This article reflects one individual's lived experience with Fibromyalgia and treatment through homeopathy. Experiences with Fibromyalgia and responses to treatment vary widely from person to person. Readers are encouraged to consult qualified medical professionals before making healthcare decisions.

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Constantly being in acute pain can be daunting and often a lonely journey. It is a space to rise and fall in stories of pain, healing, and co-existence.
